

Russell Dudek

CANDIDATE - DIRECTOR OF APPLIED AI

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<https://russelldudek.github.io/CovingtonBurling/>

Molly Winawer

Senior Staff Recruiter

Covington & Burling LLP

New York, New York

Dear Ms. Winawer:

Covington's Director of Applied AI role is not simply an AI-innovation position. It is the day-to-day operating layer between practice demand, knowledge readiness, technical delivery, responsible deployment, adoption, and measurable client-service value. The public role architecture - practice-aligned Applied AI Managers paired with Knowledge Management and Practice Technology - suggests that Covington intends to build a durable delivery function, not a collection of disconnected pilots.

That is the kind of mandate my career has prepared me to lead. At Vape-Jet, I currently direct an AI-first operating transformation across production, quality, purchasing, customer success, engineering issue flow, enterprise systems, telemetry, and software-enabled robotics. Through DudeWorth, I have built applied AI readiness and workflow patterns that connect value, data readiness, retrieval, human judgment, escalation, evaluation, governance, adoption, and reuse. At Amazon, I helped build 24/7 operating mechanisms around customer delivery at scale. At Compunetics, I led high-reliability engineering, manufacturing, quality, and cross-functional technical execution.

My thesis for Covington is: **build the common law of AI-enabled work**. A practice workflow should earn the right to scale by making its fact pattern, approved knowledge record, human authority, evaluation evidence, adoption ownership, value signal, exceptions, and maintenance responsibility explicit. That approach respects the reality that transactional, litigation, regulatory, and investigations work cannot be flattened into one generic pattern - while still allowing proven components and controls to compound across the firm.

I do not claim direct law-firm tenure, and I would enter with disciplined humility about legal doctrine, privilege, partnership governance, and matter economics. The affirmative case is that I know how to listen past the first request, lead specialists, translate across executives and technical teams, build quality mechanisms, teach new ways of working, and own outcomes through deployment. Those capabilities are central to making applied AI trusted and useful in high-consequence professional work.

I created a role-specific candidate vision at <https://russelldudek.github.io/CovingtonBurling/>. It includes an interactive Applied AI Reporter, a 120-day entry plan, an interview thesis, and a Workflow Precedent Review canvas so you can inspect how I would approach the work rather than rely on claims alone.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how Covington wants practice-specific learning to become firm capability - and where the organization most needs clearer portfolio focus, evaluation discipline, knowledge ownership, or adoption support today.

Sincerely,

Russell Dudek